Samit has huge natural ability, and I had enough faith in him as a spinner to bowl him at the death in our five-run group win over Pakistan, the eventual winners of the tournament. He came through, taking the final wicket of Zulqarnain Haider when the game was on the line. He had to deal with similar doubts about his work ethic throughout his senior international career and insists he has never missed a game for county or country through injury, but that's not actually the argument, is it?

Being in peak physical condition might have been negotiable in a previous era, but in the modern game it is a fundamental symbol of commitment. No one likes fitness sessions. There's nothing exciting about going to the gym, doing the horrible, unglorified bits. There's nothing nice about hurting yourself during those long-distance runs that never seem to end.

The Aussies call it 'ticker'. Have you got the heart to withstand tough periods, when your character is under scrutiny? Can you get through by sheer force of will? You can't replicate a critical game situation in practice, but that old cliché about the tough getting going when the going gets tough has more than a hint of truth. Guys who are genuinely successful tend to be the ones who put themselves through the sessions no one sees.

I prefer to train early in the morning. My routine at home is to get up at half past five, do some gym work and then run around the lanes between six and seven. It's a quiet time of the day, an absorbing and strangely intimate process. I am proving myself to myself, if you like. I could so easily lie in, do the work mid-morning, but there is something about being out there on my own, not really wanting to be there. Knowing you are ready to do the hard stuff adds to your self-confidence.

I'm not comparing myself to a Martin Johnson, who led England's World Cup-winning rugby team by the power of his example, but I suppose they picked me as an inexperienced captain of the Under-19s for the same reasons they asked me to lead the full team. People probably respected the way I went about things. There were no great secrets to my approach.

I worked hard, put myself on the line by opening the batting. I topped the fitness tests. I wanted others to have the same drive, and people seemed to listen to what I said. Tactically, I was too conservative in Bangladesh. I probably wasn't sufficiently assertive with the team, but that is not altogether surprising, given my youth.